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people, not places

GROUP 07





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Problem Statement:

The Disconnect in Domestic Tourism

The tourism industry favours the travellers' experiences, keeping them confined to pre-packaged tours and commercialized attractions, with little space for meaningful local engagement.

Locals, though rich in cultural knowledge and skills, often lack structured, financially viable ways to share them.

Few attempts exist to mitigate this. Digitized spaces fall short as they are not designed to improve the tourist-local relationship, while non-digitized solutions remain informal, inconsistent, and constrained by poor infrastructure.





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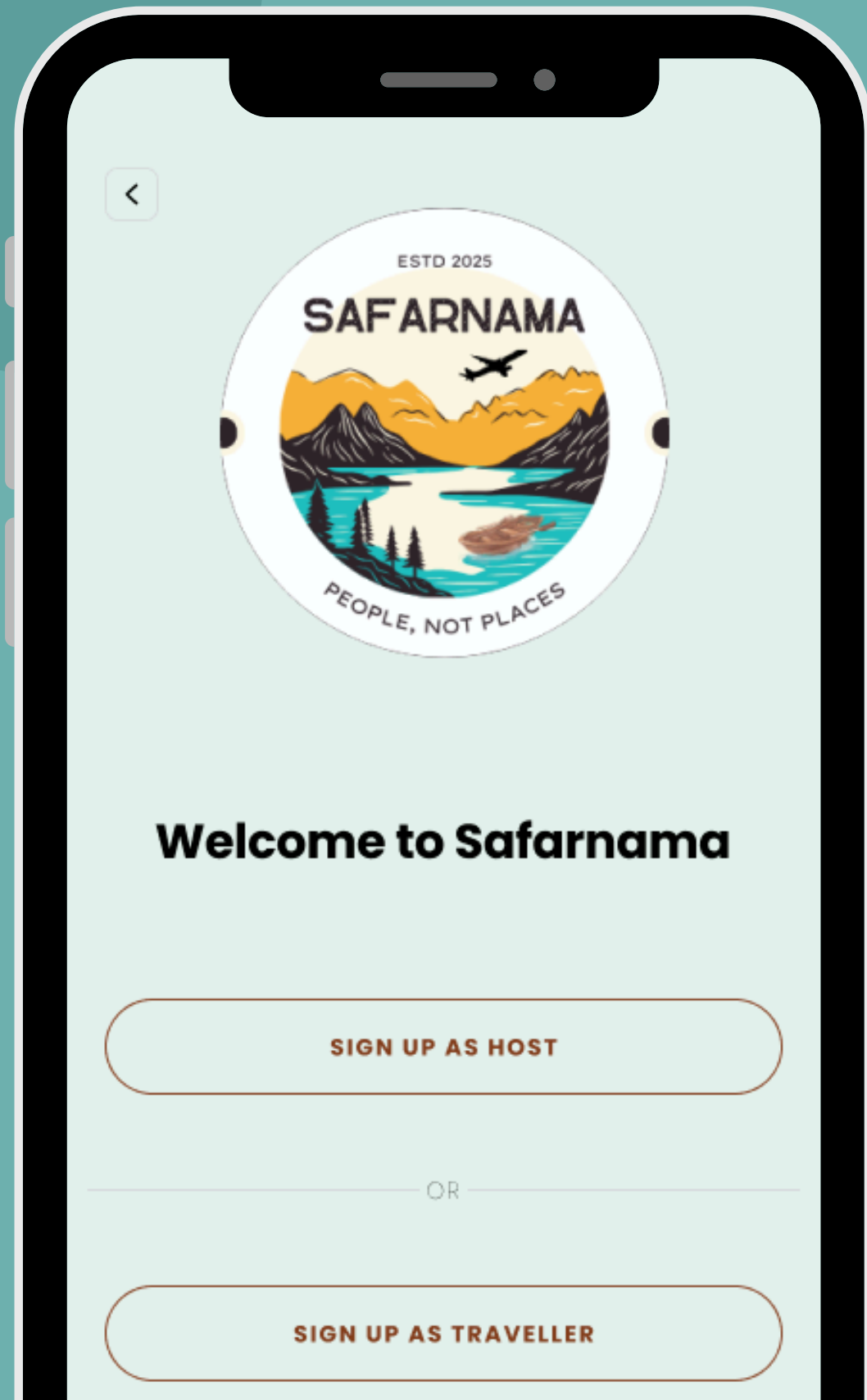
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Design Journey

- Survey (80 responses)
- Interviews (21 participants)
- Solution Design
- Testing (26 participants)





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Quantitative Research: **The Main Findings**

Key Attractions for travelers:

- Most popular: Culture, Food, Thrill, Fun, Social Experiences combined (15.6%)
- Others: Fun (9.1%), Social Experiences alone (5.2%)

Information Sources:

- Social Media alone: 15.6%
- Social Media & Travel Blogs combined: 15.6%
- Google & Social Media combined: 11.7%
- Locals exclusively: 7.8% ; Travel Blogs alone: 7.8%

Willingness to Engage:

- Positive: ~ 49% ;Negative: ~31% Conditional or hesitant: ~20%;

Experience with Local Help:

- Neutral/no significant interactions: ~56.2% ; Positive: ~43.8%

Issues faced by travelers:

- No significant issues (around 25%)
- Issues mentioned: network problems, poor sanitation (washrooms), misguidance through Google Maps



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Qualitative Research: **The Main Findings**

Opportunities and Needs

- Most contact begins via businesses (shops, transport, guesthouses)
- Locals mention that strong community networks are essential for sustainable tourism
- Economic opportunity: locals building homestays, food stalls, tour services
- Economic concerns: non-local capitalistic organizations trying to monopolize on growing tourist markets

Digital and Non-Digital Infrastructure

- Poor internet, low literacy, cash systems, and reliance on word-of-mouth hinder coordination
- Yet locals extensively use TikTok, Instagram, YouTube; prefer audio/video content over text
- Safety and transparency: demand for clear roads, emergency support, fair pricing
- Reliable information: tourists want pre-trip insights; locals want visibility



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Qualitative Research: **The Main Findings**

Tourism as a Source of Cultural Tension

- Cultural norms like parda, Muharram, respect for private land, or gendered space are often overlooked
- Privacy violations like photography without consent fuel resentment
- Locals fear cultural deterioration similar to Murree as younger generations absorb outsider behaviors and the area is commercialized beyond recognition

Trust in Tourist-Local Interactions

- Tourists report price hikes, last-minute changes, and unclear service expectations
- Locals, in turn, face distrust or accusations when payments are disputed
- The absence of structured systems creates friction
- Yet, tourists and locals report helping in times of need (natural disasters, lost, etc.)



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Findings to Features

1. Sign up as different roles.

2. Enjoy different privileges.

3. Connect with everyone directly!





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Main Features



1

Sign Up Flow

Sign-Up is through phone number and CNIC pictures. CNIC. Our application auto-fills information by parsing the picture, and sign-in/up are through OTP. This accounts for differing literacy, and ensures security.

2

Roles

Users sign up as either traveler or host – or both. Both personas have different privileges. As a traveler, register as a Travel Buddy, and as a local, sign up as a Tour Guide. Users can easily switch their roles from the settings menu.

3

Explore

As a traveler, explore spots, activities, food; see reviews for each service individually. Use the Map to see crowdsourced information. As a local, provide these services, and see your Map reviews get precedence.

4

Others

Other relevant features like SOS calls, emergency protocol PDFs, ad a general “Other Services” where locals can freelance any service they wish.



Testing Research: **The Main Findings**

Mismatch Between Labels & Mental Models

- “Explore” misread as Home; profile/settings split confused users. Users followed familiar logic that wasn’t supported in prototype. Icons, labels, and layout must align with user expectations.

Guidance Gaps & Language Confusion

- Local, Host; Traveller, Guest — these were not interchangeable for users. A clear onboarding tutorial and help screen are essential. One-line explanations often resolved confusion.

Polarized Language & Layout Feedback

- Terms like “Buddy Up” had opposing reactions; visual consistency was praised by some, criticized by others. These require further testing.

What Worked

- SOS feature universally praised. Users liked the concept, found the design practical despite prototype flaws. Several would use the app in real life. Users liked the consistency between the two profiles which they said was “easier”



Testing Research: The Main Findings

	AvgTime
sign up and log in as a traveler	37.00000
Logout	25.25000
Sign up and log in as a local	21.64706
Make a Tour Guide Profile	21.59091
List an activity in Explore Activities	26.95000
List your house as accommodation	22.72222
View other accommodations in your area	18.25000
Edit your Safarnama profile	16.17647
Add a new spot	16.93333
Make a travel buddy account	18.85714
Browse and book accommodations in your current area.	32.47059
Explore activities in your area, and view one in detail.	17.37500
Find a Travel Buddy	18.70000
Send an SOS call out	18.20000
Make an edit to your Travel Buddy profile	15.28571
Explore spots in your area	12.61111
View details of the spot	9.93750
Switch to local	6.10000
Use the map to find a location and read its reviews.	47.77778
Become a Tour Guide	22.12500
Edit your spot	10.00000

hesitant
confused
frustrated
confident
satisfied
comfortable



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